

University of Cape Town
University Examinations – May/June 2019
Department of Mathematics and Applied Mathematics
MAM3000W

Module 3MS: Metric Spaces

Time : 2 hours

Full Marks: 40

Marks available: 40

Please answer Question 1 in one answer book, and Questions 2 to 5 in another.

1. Suppose that (X, d_X) and (Y, d_Y) are metric spaces and $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a function. For $a, b \in X$, define

$$p(a, b) = d_X(a, b) + d_Y(f(a), f(b))$$

- (a) Prove carefully that p is a metric on X .
- (b) Write down the definition of the diameter of a subset of a metric space.
- (c) Now let
 - $(X, d_X) = (\mathbb{R}, d_D)$ where d_D denotes the discrete metric
 - $(Y, d_Y) = (\mathbb{R}, d_E)$ where d_E denotes the Euclidean metric
 - $f(x) = x^2$

and define p as described above. In the metric space $(\mathbb{R}, p)$:

- i. Find all real numbers in the open ball $B(\sqrt{26}; 11)$. Show brief working.
- ii. Find the diameter of the interval $[-4, 4]$. (No working required.)

[10]

Please change to a new answer book now.

2. Suppose that X and Y are metric spaces, and $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a function.

- (a) Prove that if f is continuous, then, for all $A \subseteq X$, $f(\overline{A}) \subseteq \overline{f(A)}$.
- (b) Prove or disprove:
 f is continuous if and only if, for all $B \subseteq Y$, $\overline{f^{-1}(B)} = f^{-1}(\overline{B})$.

[6]

3. Read the following theorem and proof, and then answer the questions that follow.

Theorem Suppose that (X, d) is a metric space and A is a subset of X . If A is a complete subset of X , then A is a closed subset of X .

Proof Suppose that A is complete. (1)

Take a sequence (x_n) such that $x_n \rightarrow x$ in X and $x_n \in A$ for all n . (2)

Then (x_n) is a Cauchy sequence. (3)

So $x_n \rightarrow a$ for some $a \in A$. (4)

So $x = a$, since limits are unique. (5)

So $x \in A$. (6)

- (a) Prove that every convergent sequence in (X, d) is Cauchy, as used in line (3).
- (b) How do we know that $x_n \rightarrow a$ for some $a \in A$, as claimed in line (4)?
- (c) Explain what is meant by the expression “limits are unique” (in line (5)) and prove it.
- (d) Is the converse of this theorem true or false? Prove it or disprove it. [9]

4. (a) i. Give brief reasons why, in any metric space, $B(a; r) \subseteq \text{int} B[a; r]$.
ii. Give an instance where $B(a; r) \neq \text{int} B[a; r]$.
- (b) Prove that every compact metric space is bounded.
- (c) Prove or disprove: If (X, d_X) and (Y, d_Y) are connected metric spaces, and $X \times Y$ has a metric ρ that induces componentwise convergence, then $(X \times Y, \rho)$ is connected. [12]

5. (a) For any metric space X , prove that there exists a metric space Y and an isometry $f : X \rightarrow Y$ such that $f(X)$ is not an open subset of Y .
- (b) Prove or disprove: If (X, d) is a compact metric space and $f : (X, d) \rightarrow (X, d)$ is an isometry, then f is onto. [3]

THE END